

Nordvale Robotics Employee Handbook

Version 4.2, effective 1 March 2025. This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Nordvale Robotics GmbH. Nordvale Robotics was founded in 2017 in Tallinn, Estonia, by Mira Kolvek and Jonas Aldrete. The company designs autonomous warehouse robots and employs about 340 people across offices in Tallinn, Gdansk and Lisbon.

1. Working Hours and Remote Work

The standard working week is 38 hours, Monday to Friday. Core hours, during which every employee should be reachable, are 10:00 to 15:00 local time. Outside core hours employees may organise their day flexibly, as agreed with their team lead.

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. The two office days are set by each team; most engineering teams use Tuesday and Thursday. Full remote work from another country is limited to 20 working days per calendar year and must be approved by HR at least 14 days in advance because of tax and insurance rules.

2. Vacation and Leave

Every employee receives 26 paid vacation days per year, plus public holidays. Unused vacation days can be carried over to the next year, but only up to 8 days, and they expire on 31 March of the following year.

Employees receive 5 additional paid days after completing 3 years of service. Sick leave is paid in full for the first 10 days of each calendar year; a medical certificate is required from the third consecutive day of absence.

Parental leave: the birth parent receives 16 weeks of fully paid leave and the other parent receives 6 weeks. Leave can be split into two blocks within the first 18 months after the birth.

3. Equipment and Home Office Budget

Every new employee receives a laptop chosen from the approved list (Lenovo ThinkPad T-series or Apple MacBook Pro 14). Laptops are replaced after 4 years. Developers may request a second monitor at no cost.

Employees who work remotely at least two days a week receive a one-time home office budget of 600 euros, which can be spent on a desk, chair or lighting. Receipts must be submitted through the Expenso portal within 60 days of purchase. The budget renews only after 5 years.

4. Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of 1,200 euros for courses, books and conferences. Conference travel is paid from a separate travel budget and needs approval from the team lead. Employees who attend an external conference are expected to give a 20-minute internal talk within one month of returning.

The company also runs an internal mentoring programme. New hires are paired with a mentor for their first 6 months. Mentors meet their mentees every second week and receive a bonus of 300 euros per completed mentoring cycle.

5. Travel and Expenses

Business flights must be booked in economy class through the Nordvale travel portal. Flights longer than 6 hours may be booked in premium economy. Hotel costs are reimbursed up to 140 euros per night in most European cities and up to 190 euros per night in London, Zurich and Oslo.

The daily meal allowance during business travel is 45 euros. Expense reports must be filed within 30 days after the trip, otherwise reimbursement may be refused. Personal car use is reimbursed at 0.28 euros per kilometre.

6. Information Security

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must be changed every 180 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all company accounts, including email, the code repository and the VPN. Employees must lock their screen when leaving their desk.

Any suspected security incident, such as a lost laptop or a phishing email that was clicked, must be reported to the security team at security@nordvale.example within 2 hours of discovery. Reporting quickly is never punished, even if the employee made a mistake.

Customer data from warehouse deployments may only be accessed on company laptops and only through the VPN. Copying customer data to personal devices or private cloud storage is strictly forbidden.

7. Code of Conduct

Nordvale Robotics does not tolerate harassment or discrimination of any kind. Employees can report concerns to their manager, to HR, or anonymously through the Speak-Up line operated by an external provider. Every report is reviewed within 5 working days.

Gifts from suppliers or customers with a value above 50 euros must be declared to the compliance officer and may not be accepted without written approval.

8. Compensation and Benefits

Salaries are paid on the last working day of each month. Salary reviews take place twice a year, in April and October. Employees who refer a successful candidate who stays for at least 6 months receive a referral bonus of 1,500 euros.

The company covers 80 percent of the cost of a private health insurance plan. Employees can also join the Nordvale Sports Club programme, which reimburses up to 40 euros per month for gym or sports memberships.